

SAMUEL LEIGH

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EDUCATION

London School of Economics and Political Science

Sep 2024 – Jun 2027

BA International History (Expected: First Class Honours)

- First-year average: First Class; modules include HY113 Empires and Resistance in Global History (First, 78; top 5% of 105-student cohort), EC1A3 Microeconomics (First), HY120 Historical Approaches to the Modern World (First), and LSE100 Understanding the Causes of Things (First)
- Second-year modules: IR203 International Organisations, HY245 US territorial expansion and the political economy of consolidation, HY206 the Cold War and the Sino-Soviet split, HY319 Napoleonic-era economic structures
- Researcher, LSESU Economics Society (Feb 2026 – Present): contributing to an ongoing quantitative research project, working on research design and on the selection and evaluation of cross-country economic and institutional data sources
- Student participation: Government Society Member, Consulting Society Member, Pickleball Society Treasurer (managing an annual budget of £820)

Harvey Grammar School

Sep 2017 – Jun 2024

- A-Levels: History (A), Physics (A), Mathematics (A), Further Mathematics (B)
- GCSEs: 99988886 – 7 A*s including Grade 9s in Mathematics and English Language

EXPERIENCE

Student Consultant

July 2026

Missang Advisory, London (live client project via the LSE Skills Accelerator)

- Worked within a student consulting team to produce and deliver a comparative policy report for a Westminster-based geostrategy and critical minerals advisory, examining the United Kingdom's largely absent sovereign-level framework for minerals partnerships with Africa
- Benchmarked leading international frameworks, including the US Minerals Security Partnership and the EU Critical Raw Materials Act, against criteria of policy design and stakeholder engagement, and developed recommendations for how the client could engage and shape UK policy
- Presented the findings and recommendations to the client

Volunteer Boat & Shore Crew

Sep 2023 – Present

Royal National Lifeboat Institution (RNLI), Littlestone Lifeboat Station, Kent (third-generation volunteer; also inducted at Tower Lifeboat Station, London)

- Serve as volunteer boat and shore crew at the station, supporting search and rescue operations in response to HM Coastguard taskings; responsibilities include crewing on operational callouts, supporting launches and recoveries, casualty care, and ongoing training to maintain operational readiness
- On operational callouts, assess scene conditions under time pressure with incomplete and rapidly evolving information (casualty count, weather, vessel status) and coordinate with HM Coastguard, police, and ambulance to determine and execute the appropriate response
- Identified unused capacity in the station's navigation system and programmed pre-plotted routes to key callout locations with hazards marked in, securing senior helm sign-off and reducing launch preparation time from around 2 minutes to 30 seconds at zero cost; now standard practice at the station
- Interviewed live on BBC Radio Kent: translated maritime jargon into accessible public language and incorporated the "float to live" cold-water survival message; received positive feedback from the lifeboat operations manager

Secretary

Apr 2025 – 2026

LSE Raising and Giving (RAG), London

- Coordinated scheduling and committee administration for a student-run charity, managing relationships across a 40+ member committee and university administration, and drafting minutes and committee communications in line with Students' Union requirements
- Identified an untapped alumni network and built an engagement programme from scratch, conducting outreach via LinkedIn and the university's alumni relations team; the speaker series contributed to growing Giving Tuesday fundraising from £536 to over £1,000 year-on-year (+87%)
- Previously served as Charity Officer (Oct 2024 – Apr 2025), contributing to a £14,000 fundraising total for partners including Safe Passage International through event planning and donor outreach

Campaign Volunteer

Spring – Summer 2024

Damian Collins MP, 2024 General Election Campaign, Folkestone and Hythe

- Contributed to canvassing and voter contact in a marginal constituency during the 2024 general election cycle

AI LITERACY

- **Anthropic Claude:** Daily user for over a year for research, drafting, and code generation; certified in Anthropic Claude 101, AI Fluency for Nonprofits, and AI Capabilities and Limitations

Finalist, Fullhouse Poker Bot Hackathon

June 2026

Sponsored by Quadrature Capital, London

- Reached the finals of the United Kingdom's first poker bot competition, placing in the top 64 of a field of around 190 entrants after two Swiss qualifier rounds, against students from Oxford, Cambridge, Imperial, UCL and KCL
- Built a six-max No-Limit Hold'em bot around Monte Carlo equity estimation and a live Bayesian opponent-modelling layer that adjusted its decision thresholds within a single match
- Validated each change on roughly 100,000 simulated matches using variance-reduced paired-seed A/B tests, with decision rules fixed before results were seen

Rightmove Property Analysis Tool

2025

AI-assisted build; a prototype rather than an enterprise tool

- Built a web scraper with a weighted scoring engine and Excel output, extracting fields the Rightmove interface does not surface (square footage, service charges, ground rent, lease years, EPC ratings, council tax band)
- Scores each property from 0 to 100 against weighted criteria, with a settings interface for adjusting the weights without touching code, and TfL API integration for commute-time calculations; ranked output tracks changes over time

PARLIAMENTARY ENGAGEMENT

15+ Select Committee hearings attended in person, including:

- Treasury Committee, "The OBR: 15 Years On" (HC 1583, 25 February 2026), with Richard Hughes and Sir Robert Chote: the OBR forecasting record against the Treasury, dynamic scoring of supply-side policy, and the politics of fiscal headroom
- Economic Affairs Committee, "Preparing for an Ageing Society" (14 October 2025), with James Murray MP as Chief Secretary to the Treasury: the pensions investment review, the Casey social care review, and economic inactivity among older workers
- International Relations and Defence Committee on international law and the rules-based order, with Professor Marc Weller and Professor Schmitt: humanitarian intervention doctrine, Kosovo, and the use of legal justification in Russia and Ukraine

SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

- **Policy Research & Analysis:** Desk-based research, source evaluation, and structured written deliverables for client and general audiences, developed through the Missang Advisory comparative policy report and first-year LSE coursework (HY113 First; HY120 First)
- **Quantitative:** First in EC1A3 Microeconomics and A-Level Further Mathematics; engagement with quantitative research design and cross-country data sources through the Economics Society research project; simulation-based testing and controlled experiment design through the Fullhouse hackathon
- **Communication:** Live broadcast on BBC Radio Kent, a client presentation at Missang Advisory, two presentations delivered to the LSESU Economics Society, and committee correspondence and minutes at RAG
- **Technical Skills:** Microsoft Office (Excel, PowerPoint, Word, Outlook, SharePoint), Anthropic Claude
- **Certifications:** RNLI Lifeboat Casualty Care, STCW Personal Survival Techniques, STCW Elementary First Aid
- **Awards:** A-Level Prize and GCSE Prize (both for top 10 grades in school), History Ambassador

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Financial Markets & Commercial Awareness:** As part of a team, pitched a long equity thesis on Porsche AG at the Oxford Inter-University Stock Pitch Competition 2026, identifying a margin recovery catalyst from the company's EV-to-ICE strategic pivot
- **Current Affairs & Policy:** Daily reader of the Financial Times since age 13; follows policy research from the Institute for Government, Chatham House, the IISS, and Bruegel